WIRE FRAUD NOTICE

WFN

This form recommended and approved for, but not restricted to use by, the members of the Pennsylvania Association of Realtors® (PAR).

Scammers are hacking the email accounts of title companies, real estate agents, settlement attorneys and others resulting in fraudulent wire instructions being used to divert funds to the account of the hacker. This behavior can be common in real estate transactions because sensitive data such as social security numbers, bank account numbers and wiring instructions are often sent by unsecured email for transactions involving large amounts of money. **DO NOT** provide personal information such as social security numbers, bank account numbers and credit card numbers except through secured email or personal delivery to the intended recipient.

If you receive an email with wiring instructions or an email changing the wiring instructions:

1. **DO NOT wire any funds without personally speaking with the intended recipient of the wire, even if the email appears to be from someone you know.** Confirm the instructions, routing number and account number.

2. **Call a verified phone number, not the phone number provided in the email!** The emails include information intended to look legitimate and may appear to be from a familiar name or email address and may even contain a company logo and other symbols meant to gain your trust.

3. **If you believe you have received questionable or suspicious wire transfer instructions, immediately notify your bank, the escrow agent, and your real estate professional.** Once money has been wired it is almost always unrecoverable. Banks are not responsible for funds that are voluntarily wired to a fraudulent account. If you suspect that you have been victimized by wire fraud, contact the local office of the Federal Bureau of Investigations or file a complaint with the Internet Crime Complaint Center at www.ic3.gov.

CONSUMER _____ **DATE** _____
PRINTED NAME _____
CONSUMER _____ **DATE** _____
PRINTED NAME _____
CONSUMER _____ **DATE** _____
PRINTED NAME _____

BROKER (COMPANY) _____
LICENSEE _____ **DATE** _____

Pennsylvania Association of Realtors®

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Phone: Fax:
Produced with Lone Wolf Transactions (zipForm Edition) 717 N Harwood St, Suite 2200, Dallas, TX 75201 www.lwolf.com